The Future of Work and Organizations

Topic 2: Individual Differences



Dr. Mary Parkinson

…Starting from improved self-awareness



Question

Should you choose a team based on skills or personality?

A: Skills

B: Personality

A is correct- always go skills first!



Question

How is ‘treat others how you would like to be treated’ a **good** starting principle for working with others?

How is ‘treat others how you would like to be treated’ a **bad** starting principle for working with others?



Personality

- **Defined as the sum total of ways in which an individual reacts to and interacts with others**
- Most often described in terms of measurable traits that a person exhibits, such as shy, loyal, aggressive
- The interactionist perspective: Personality + Situation = Behaviour



The Influence of Individual Differences at Work

Person-job fit theory; fit between personality type and occupational environment determines job satisfaction and turnover

6 personality types

Person- organization fit; people are attracted to and selected by organizations that match their personality and values, and leave when there is no compatibility

Note- both of these frameworks are less effective in Asia than North America

Personality has been linked to project success/team leadership (e.g. Creasy and Anantatmula, 2013; Cohen, Ornoy & Keren, 2013; Hassan, Bashir & Abbas, 2017).

- However, this is not our focus…

(Malloy, 1996; Ormiston et al., 2021; Harrison et al., 2020)

There are many ways to capture personality

- Belbin Team Roles
- MBTI
- We're using the five-factor model because it's scientifically developed and well validated, with good test-retest reliability.
  - But there is quite a bit of overlap between scales.

Five Factor Personality Quiz Results

Factor	Factor label	Raw score	Score percentile
I	**Extroversion**		90
II	**Emotional stability**		89
III	**Agreeableness**		80
IV	**Conscientiousness**		46
V	**Intellect/Imagination**		59

Big five personality trait scores calculated by openpsychometrics.org

Plan a holiday

- Groups are based on the traits which you scored lowest/highest on.
  - High vs. low extraversion
  - High vs. low openness (note this is listed on the quiz as “Intellect/Imagination”).
- All of the students in each group will be traveling to the same place and need to plan this out today.
- The trip does not have to be realistic.
- Take 10 minutes to plan.



Plan a Holiday

- Visualise the plan on a whiteboard (you will be asked to share later!)
- Questions that you should answer as a group include:

- Where will your group go?
- What will you pack?
- Who will you bring?
- What will you do while you are there?
- Anything else that your group thinks is important for the trip?

Holiday Planning Debrief- The Five Factor Model



McCrae & Costa (1987)
Measures personality traits (or dimensions)

Holiday Planning Debrief- The Five Factor Model







A tendency to enjoy new experiences and new ideas.

High: imaginative, witty, and having broad interests

Low: down-to-earth, simple, and having narrow interests.

McCrae & Costa (1987)

Holiday Planning Debrief- The Five Factor Model





A tendency to show self-discipline, and to strive for competence and achievement.

High: well-organized, careful, self-disciplined, responsible, and precise

Low: disorganized, impulsive, careless, and undependable at the low end.

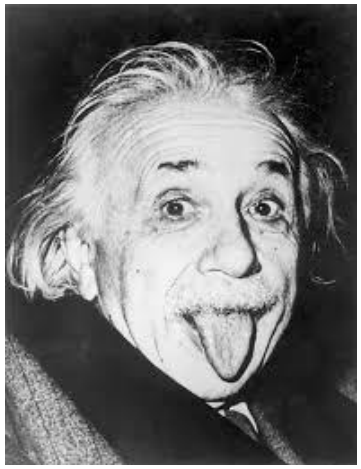
McCrae & Costa (1987)
Measures personality traits (or dimensions)

PEOPLE, PEOPLE EVERYWHERE



Holiday Planning Debrief- The Five Factor Model





McCrae & Costa (1987)



A tendency to seek stimulation and to enjoy the company of other people.

High: energetic, enthusiastic, sociable, and talkative at the high end

Low: retiring, sober, reserved, silent, and cautious at the low end.

Holiday Planning Debrief- The Five Factor Model







A tendency to be compassionate toward others.

High: good-natured, cooperative, trusting, and helpful

Low: irritable, suspicious, and uncooperative.

McCrae & Costa (1987)

Holiday Planning Debrief- The Five Factor Model



*the scale we are using refers to this as 'emotional stability'

A tendency to experience unpleasant emotions easily.

High: nervous, anxious, high-strung, and hypochondriacal

Low: poised, calm, composed, and not hypochondriacal

McCrae & Costa (1987)

Discussion

1. How might communication breakdown occur between Es and Is?

2. How might conflict arise in teams with mixed levels of conscientiousness?

3. What are the upsides and downsides of highly agreeable teams?

4. Who is most likely to end up in a leadership role?

Big 5 and Work

- Lower Neuroticism/higher emotional stability: higher job satisfaction, lower stress, greater adaptability to change
- Extraversion- associated with leadership, higher performance higher job satisfaction
- Openness- associated with leadership and learning/development
- Agreeableness- higher performance (although findings are somewhat mixed)
- Conscientiousness- higher performance, leadership
- Differences in conscientiousness across a team predict poor performance.

(Judge et al., 2002; Spark et al., 2022)

When does personality predict behavior?

- Situation strength theory proposes that the way personality translates into behavior depends on the strength of the situation.
- Situation strength= the degree to which norms, cues, or standards dictate appropriate behavior.
  - Clarity, consistency, constraints, consequences

- Trait Activation Theory predicts that some situations, events, or interventions “activate” a trait more than others.
  - E.g. creative jobs activate ‘openness’ more than a medical technician.



Poll: Who thinks that they would like leadership?

Introverted Leaders

- Introverts can be excellent leaders, but they often don't think they'll like it, so don't apply for leadership jobs (Spark, Stansmore, & O'Connor, 2018).
- But they may be wrong- often introverts like leadership in spite of 'behaving like extraverts' (Zelenski et al., 2013)
- The power of introverts (Cain, 2012).

Introverted Leaders: Effectiveness

- Extraverted leaders are more effective when employees are **passive**, but introverts are more effective when employees are **active**. (Grant, Gino & Hoffman, 2011)
- Social skills might be the important thing (Guerin et al., 2011)

- Bias favoring extroverts at work (e.g. McCord et al., 2020)

Core-Self evaluations

- Among the best dispositional predictors of job satisfaction and performance.
  - **Self-esteem**—The overall value one places on oneself as a person
  - **Generalized self-efficacy**—A person's beliefs about his or her capacity to perform tasks successfully
  - **Locus of control**—The extent to which individuals feel that they are able to control things in a manner that affects them
  - **Emotional stability**—The tendency to see oneself as confident, secure, and steady (five factor)



Robbins et al., 2016

Task

How might you boost self esteem/self-efficacy as a leader?



Ways to boost self esteem/self-efficacy

Catch people in the act of doing something right!

Make people feel:

- Uniquely valuable.
- Competent.
- Secure.
- Empowered.
- Give constructive, not destructive feedback.
- Expose people to models of good performance—and success.
- Seek continuous improvement.

Robbins et al., 2016

Critique of personality testing in organizations

- What are some good and bad sides of personality testing in organizations?
- Do you personally like it?
- Widely used for hiring, suitability for promotion, leadership development
- Benefits:
  - Predict job performance (with some caveats)
  - Improve person-job and person-organisation fit
  - Enhance self-awareness and development

(Morgeson et al., 2008; Robbins & Judge, 2024)

Critique of personality testing in organizations

- Limitations:
  - Self-report bias / ‘faking good’
  - Snapshot of behaviour
  - Neglect of situational influences
  - Questions of stability and validity

How do you feel about an AI driven personality test?
https://www.apa.org/news/podcasts/speaking-of-psychology/personality-tests

(Morgeson et al., 2008; Robbins & Judge, 2024)

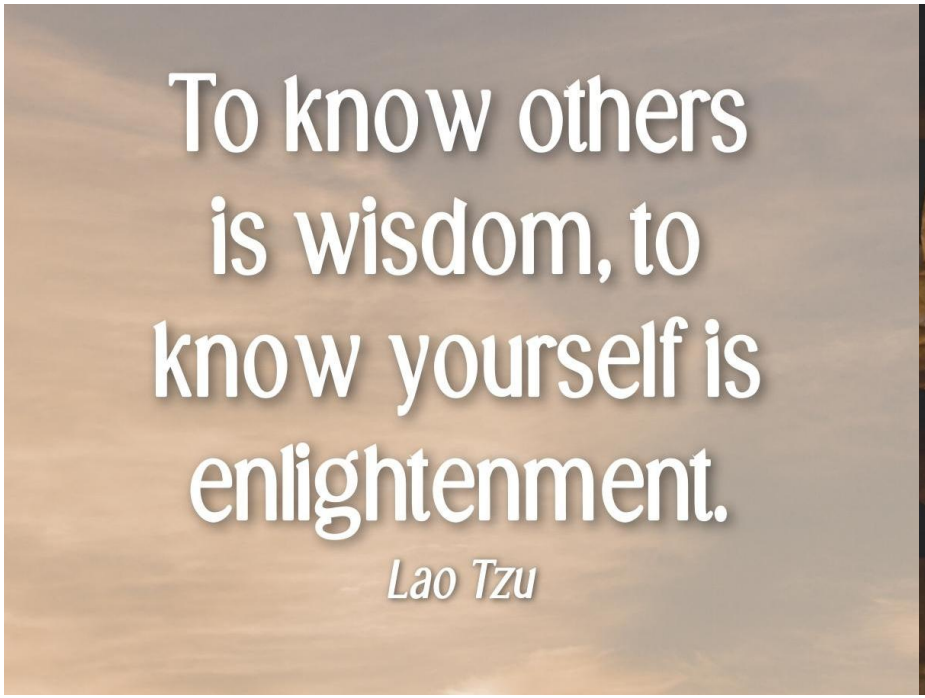
Critique of personality testing in organizations

- Criticisms:
  - Can lead to oversimplification and labelling
  - Reduces individuals to fixed categories
  - Questionable reliability and validity
  - Cultural bias and interpretation issues

- Implications for hiring and teamwork:
  - Useful but probabilistic not perfect prediction
  - Risk of over-reliance and bias
  - importance of diversity

(Morgeson et al., 2008; Robbins & Judge, 2024)

Wrapping up


To know others is wisdom, to know yourself is enlightenment.
Lao Tzu


Find out who you are and do it on purpose.
Dolly Parton

END

References

Dasborough, M. T., Ashkanasy, N. M., Humphrey, R. H., Harms, P. D., Credé, M., & Wood, D. (2021). Does leadership still not need emotional intelligence? Continuing "The Great EI Debate". *The Leadership Quarterly*, 101539.

Goleman, D. (2020). What people (still) get wrong about emotional intelligence. *Harvard Business Review Digital Articles*, 2-4.

Grant, A. M., Gino, F., & Hofmann, D. A. (2011). Reversing the extraverted leadership advantage: The role of employee proactivity. *Academy Of Management Journal*, *54*(3), 528-550. doi:10.5465/AMJ.2011.61968043

Guerin, D.W., Oliver, P.H., Gottfried, A.W., Gottfried, A.E., Reichard, R.J., & Riggio, R.E. (2011). Childhood and adolescent antecedents of social skills and leadership potential in adulthood: Temperamental approach/withdrawal and extraversion. The Leadership Quarterly, 22(3), 482-494.

Harrison, J. S., Thurgood, G. R., Boivie, S., & Pfarrer, M. D. (2020). Perception is reality: how CEOs' observed personality influences market perceptions of firm risk and shareholder returns. *Academy of Management Journal*, *63*(4), 1166-1195.

Hickman, G. R. (1998). *Leading organizations: Perspectives for a new era*. Sage.

References

Hur, Y., Van Den Berg, P. T., & Wilderom, C. P. (2011). Transformational leadership as a mediator between emotional intelligence and team outcomes. *The Leadership Quarterly*, *22*(4), 591-603.

Janssen, O., & Van Yperen, N. W. (2004). Employees' goal orientations, the quality of leader-member exchange, and the outcomes of job performance and job satisfaction. *Academy of management journal*, *47*(3), 368-384.

Malloy, A. (1996, June). Counting the intangibles. Computerworld (pp. 31–33).

McCord, M. A., & Joseph, D. L. (2020). A framework of negative responses to introversion at work. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *161*, 109944.

Morgeson, F. P., Campion, M. A., Dipboye, R. L., Hollenbeck, J. R., Murphy, K., & Schmitt, N. (2007). "Reconsidering the use of personality tests in personnel selection contexts." Personnel Psychology, 60(3), 683–729.

Ormiston, M. E., Wong, E. M., & Ha, J. (2021). The role of CEO emotional stability and team heterogeneity in shaping the top management team affective tone and firm performance relationship. *The Leadership Quarterly*, 101543.

Peterson, R. S., Smith, D. B., Martorana, P. V., & Owens, P. D. (2003). The impact of chief executive officer personality on top management team dynamics: one mechanism by which leadership affects organizational performance. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, *88*(5), 795.

References

Riggio, R.E., & Reichard, R. J. (2008). The emotional and social intelligences of effective leadership: An emotional and social skill *approach Journal of Managerial Psychology*, 23(2), 169-185.

Schaubroeck, J., Lam, S. S., & Cha, S. E. (2007). Embracing transformational leadership: team values and the impact of leader behavior on team performance. *Journal of Applied psychology*, *92*(4), 1020.

Spark, A., Stansmore, T., & O'Connor, P. (2018). The failure of introverts to emerge as leaders: The role of forecasted affect. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *121*, 84-88.

Spark, A., O'Connor, P. J., Jimmieson, N. L., & Niessen, C. (2022). Is the transition to formal leadership caused by trait extraversion? A counterfactual hazard analysis using two large panel datasets. *The Leadership Quarterly*, *33*(2), 101565.

Volmer, J., Koch, I. K., & Göritz, A. S. (2016). The bright and dark sides of leaders' dark triad traits: Effects on subordinates' career success and well-being. *Personality and Individual Differences*, *101*, 413-418.

For tomorrow- make sure you are registered for Harvard cases and simulations!

The Dark Triad

A **narcissist,** a **psychopath**, and a **Machiavellian** feature in a comedy show lineup.

The narcissist thinks they got the best applause, the psychopath doesn't care, and the Machiavellian actually gets the best applause, though at the expense of the other two.

Larry Ellison (Oracle CEO)- "The difference between God and Larry is that God does not believe he is Larry".

Volmer et al., 2016

Rate each statement: 1=strongly agree, 5=strongly disagree.

- I know why my emotions change.
- I easily recognize my emotions as I experience them.
- I can tell how people are feeling by listening to the tone of their voice.
- By looking at their facial expressions, I recognize the emotions people are experiencing.
- I seek out activities that make me happy.
- I have control over my emotions.
- I arrange events others enjoy.
- I help other people feel better when they are down.
- When I am in a positive mood, I am able to come up with new ideas.
- I use good moods to help myself keep trying in the face of obstacles.

Emotional intelligence

- Emotional intelligence refers to the abilities to recognize and regulate emotions in ourselves and in others (Goleman, 2001
- Your emotional intelligence (EI) determines your success as a leader (Salovey & Meyer, 1990; Goleman, 2002).

- EI has four elements:
  - self-awareness
  - self-management
  - social awareness
  - managing relationships



(West, 2012, p80; Goleman, 2002; Seligman, 1

The BEIS (Davis et al., 2010)

- **1. Appraisal of Own Emotions**
- I know why my emotions change.
- I easily recognize my emotions as I experience them.
- **2. Appraisal of Others' Emotions**
- I can tell how people are feeling by listening to the tone of their voice.
- By looking at their facial expressions, I recognize the emotions people are experiencing.
- **3. Regulation of Own Emotions**
- I seek out activities that make me happy.
- I have control over my emotions.
- **4. Regulation of Others' Emotions**
- I arrange events others enjoy.
- I help other people feel better when they are down.
- **5. Utilization of Emotions**
- When I am in a positive mood, I am able to come up with new ideas.
- I use good moods to help myself keep trying in the face of obstacles.

Emotional intelligence

- It’s not the same as being nice!

- Beware of manipulation
  - Empathic concern

(Goleman, 2020)



Emotional intelligence- Caveats

However, debate rages on! (Dasborough et al., 2021; Antonakis et al., 2009, p. 247)

Is it an ability or an emotional personality trait? (Salovey & Grewal,2005; Petrides, Pita, & Kokkinaki, 2007)



(West, 2012, p80; Goleman, 2002; Seligman, 1998)